Colt Single Action Army (SAA 1873 Peacemaker)

Colt's Manufacturing • Model P 1873 'The Gun That Won the West' (.45 Colt & .357 Magnum)

Manufacturer:	Colt's Manufacturing	**Category:**	Revolvers
Action Type:	Single-Action Revolver (4-Click Lockwork)	**Era / Service:**	American Frontier (1873–Present)
Calibers:	.45 Colt, .357 Magnum, .44-40 Winchester	**Covered Models:**	Colt SAA 1873, Peacemaker 4.75", Artillery Model 5.5", Cavalry Model 7.5"

KEY ARMORER TASKS & BENCH OPERATIONS

Core Procedures: 4-Click Hammer Notch Stoning • Hand & Bolt Flat Spring Replacement • Cylinder Base Pin Latch Service • Half-Cock Safety Inspection • Loading Gate Detent Fitting

CRITICAL ARMORER TOLERANCES & SPECIFICATIONS

SPECIFICATION / CLEARANCE	ARMORER TOLERANCE & BENCH SPECIFICATION
4 CLICK COCKING	Hammer makes 4 distinct clicks spelling C-O-L-T: 1. Safety notch, 2. Half-cock loading notch, 3. Cylinder bolt drops, 4. Full-cock sear engagement
SAFETY PROTOCOL	HISTORIC SAFETY RULE: Always load five cartridges and lower hammer down onto an EMPTY chamber to prevent drop discharge
CYLINDER BOLT TIMING	Bolt must drop into cylinder notch flute ramp approximately 1/8" before locking notch
HAMMER NOTCH MAINTENANCE	Safety and half-cock notches are fragile and will shear if trigger is pulled while on half-cock

IMMEDIATE ACTION & MALFUNCTION DIAGNOSTIC MATRIX

MALFUNCTION CONDITION	PROBABLE CAUSES	ARMORER BENCH REMEDY
Stoppage 1: Broken Hand and Bolt Spring (Cylinder Free-Wheeling) **Cylinder bolt does not pop up to lock cylinder, or hand fails to rotate cylinder on hammer cock**	• Fracture of the dual-leg flat combination spring inside lower frame. • Dirt and hardened oil locking the bolt pivot screw.	**Gunsmith Action: Disassemble backstrap and trigger guard. Replace broken flat spring with modern piano-wire spring replacement (Wolff or Heinie wire spring) which eliminates flat-leaf breakage permanently.**

CURATED BENCH VIDEO REFERENCES

PROCEDURE TITLE	INSTRUCTOR / CREATOR	TECHNICAL PROCEDURE SUMMARY
Colt Single Action Army Complete Disassembly & Tuning	Mark Novak / Anvil Gunsmithing	Mark Novak teardown of the 1873 Peacemaker, tuning the combination bolt/hand spring, timing cylinder lockup, and repairing damaged half-cock notches.